

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 35

Habakkuk

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 35

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Habakkuk

Habakkuk 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The problem as God gave Habakkuk to see it:
- 1 The oracle that Habakkuk the prophet received.
- 2 GOD, how long do I have to cry out for help before you listen? How many times do I have to yell, "Help! Murder! Police!" before you come to the rescue?
- 2 How long, O LORD, must I call for help, but you do not listen? Or cry out to you, "Violence!" but you do not save?
- 3 Why do you force me to look at evil, stare trouble in the face day after day? Anarchy and violence break out, quarrels and fights all over the place.
- 3 Why do you make me look at injustice? Why do you tolerate wrong? Destruction and violence are before me; there is strife, and conflict abounds.
- 4 Law and order fall to pieces. Justice is a joke. The wicked have the righteous hamstrung and stand justice on its head.
- 4 Therefore the law is paralyzed, and justice never prevails. The wicked hem in the righteous, so that justice is perverted.
- 5 "Look around at the godless nations. Look long and hard. Brace yourself for a shock. Something's about to take place and you're going to find it hard to believe.
- 5 Look at the nations and watch-- and be utterly amazed. For I am going to do something in your days that you would not believe, even if you were told.
- 6 I'm about to raise up Babylonians to punish you, Babylonians, fierce and ferocious-- World-conquering Babylon, grabbing up nations right and left,

- 6 I am raising up the Babylonians, that ruthless and impetuous people, who sweep across the whole earth to seize dwelling places not their own.
- 7 A dreadful and terrible people, making up its own rules as it goes.
- 7 They are a feared and dreaded people; they are a law to themselves and promote their own honor.
- 8 Their horses run like the wind, attack like bloodthirsty wolves. A stampede of galloping horses thunders out of nowhere. They descend like vultures circling in on carrion.
- 8 Their horses are swifter than leopards, fiercer than wolves at dusk. Their cavalry gallops headlong; their horsemen come from afar. They fly like a vulture swooping to devour;
- 9 They're out to kill. Death is on their minds. They collect victims like squirrels gathering nuts.
- 9 they all come bent on violence. Their hordes advance like a desert wind and gather prisoners like sand.
- 10 They mock kings, poke fun at generals, Spit on forts, and leave them in the dust.
- 10 They deride kings and scoff at rulers. They laugh at all fortified cities; they build earthen ramps and capture them.
- 11 They'll all be blown away by the wind. Brazen in sin, they call strength their god."
- 11 Then they sweep past like the wind and go on-- guilty men, whose own strength is their god."
- 12 GOD, you're from eternity, aren't you? Holy God, we aren't going to die, are we? GOD, you chose Babylonians for your judgment work? Rock-Solid God, you gave them the job of discipline?
- 12 O LORD, are you not from everlasting? My God, my Holy One, we will not die. O LORD, you have appointed them to execute judgment; O Rock, you have ordained them to punish.
- 13 But you can't be serious! You can't condone evil! So why don't you do something about this? Why are you silent now? This outrage! Evil men swallow up the righteous and you stand around and watch!
- 13 Your eyes are too pure to look on evil; you cannot tolerate wrong. Why then do you tolerate the treacherous? Why are you silent while the wicked swallow up those more righteous than themselves?

- 14 You're treating men and women as so many fish in the ocean,
Swimming without direction, swimming but not getting anywhere.
- 14 You have made men like fish in the sea, like sea creatures that have no ruler.
- 15 Then this evil Babylonian arrives and goes fishing. He pulls in a good catch. He catches his limit and fills his creel-- a good day of fishing! He's happy!
- 15 The wicked foe pulls all of them up with hooks, he catches them in his net, he gathers them up in his dragnet; and so he rejoices and is glad.
- 16 He praises his rod and reel, piles his fishing gear on an altar and worships it! It's made his day, and he's going to eat well tonight!
- 16 Therefore he sacrifices to his net and burns incense to his dragnet, for by his net he lives in luxury and enjoys the choicest food.
- 17 Are you going to let this go on and on? Will you let this Babylonian fisherman Fish like a weekend angler, killing people as if they're nothing but fish?
- 17 Is he to keep on emptying his net, destroying nations without mercy?

Habakkuk 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 What's God going to say to my questions? I'm braced for the worst. I'll climb to the lookout tower and scan the horizon. I'll wait to see what God says, how he'll answer my complaint.
- 1 I will stand at my watch and station myself on the ramparts; I will look to see what he will say to me, and what answer I am to give to this complaint.
- 2 And then GOD answered: "Write this. Write what you see. Write it out in big block letters so that it can be read on the run.
- 2 Then the LORD replied: "Write down the revelation and make it plain on tablets so that a herald may run with it.
- 3 This vision-message is a witness pointing to what's coming. It aches for the coming--it can hardly wait! And it doesn't lie. If it seems slow in coming, wait. It's on its way. It will come right on time.

- 3 For the revelation awaits an appointed time; it speaks of the end and will not prove false. Though it linger, wait for it; it will certainly come and will not delay.
- 4 "Look at that man, bloated by self-importance-- full of himself but soul-empty. But the person in right standing before God through loyal and steady believing is fully alive, really alive.
- 4 See, he is puffed up; his desires are not upright-- but the righteous will live by his faith--
- 5 "Note well: Money deceives. The arrogant rich don't last. They are more hungry for wealth than the grave is for cadavers. Like death, they always want more, but the 'more' they get is dead bodies. They are cemeteries filled with dead nations, graveyards filled with corpses.
- 5 indeed, wine betrays him; he is arrogant and never at rest. Because he is as greedy as the grave and like death is never satisfied, he gathers to himself all the nations and takes captive all the peoples.
- 6 Don't give people like this a second thought. Soon the whole world will be taunting them: "'Who do you think you are-- getting rich by stealing and extortion? How long do you think you can get away with this?'
- 6 Will not all of them taunt him with ridicule and scorn, saying, 'Woe to him who piles up stolen goods and makes himself wealthy by extortion! How long must this go on?'
- 7 Indeed, how long before your victims wake up, stand up and make you the victim?
- 7 Will not your debtors suddenly arise? Will they not wake up and make you tremble? Then you will become their victim.
- 8 You've plundered nation after nation. Now you'll get a taste of your own medicine. All the survivors are out to plunder you, a payback for all your murders and massacres.
- 8 Because you have plundered many nations, the peoples who are left will plunder you. For you have shed man's blood; you have destroyed lands and cities and everyone in them.
- 9 "Who do you think you are-- recklessly grabbing and looting, Living it up, acting like king of the mountain, acting above it all, above trials and troubles?
- 9 Woe to him who builds his realm by unjust gain to set his nest on high, to escape the clutches of ruin!

- 10 You've engineered the ruin of your own house. In ruining others you've ruined yourself. You've undermined your foundations, rotted out your own soul.
- 10 You have plotted the ruin of many peoples, shaming your own house and forfeiting your life.
- 11 The bricks of your house will speak up and accuse you. The woodwork will step forward with evidence.
- 11 The stones of the wall will cry out, and the beams of the woodwork will echo it.
- 12 "Who do you think you are-- building a town by murder, a city with crime?
- 12 Woe to him who builds a city with bloodshed and establishes a town by crime!
- 13 Don't you know that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies makes sure nothing comes of that but ashes, Makes sure the harder you work at that kind of thing, the less you are?
- 13 Has not the LORD Almighty determined that the people's labor is only fuel for the fire, that the nations exhaust themselves for nothing?
- 14 Meanwhile the earth fills up with awareness of GOD's glory as the waters cover the sea.
- 14 For the earth will be filled with the knowledge of the glory of the LORD, as the waters cover the sea.
- 15 "Who do you think you are-- inviting your neighbors to your drunken parties, Giving them too much to drink, roping them into your sexual orgies?
- 15 Woe to him who gives drink to his neighbors, pouring it from the wineskin till they are drunk, so that he can gaze on their naked bodies.
- 16 You thought you were having the time of your life. Wrong! It's a time of disgrace. All the time you were drinking, you were drinking from the cup of God's wrath.
- 16 You will be filled with shame instead of glory. Now it is your turn! Drink and be exposed! The cup from the LORD's right hand is coming around to you, and disgrace will cover your glory.
- 17 You'll wake up holding your throbbing head, hung over-- hung over from Lebanon violence, Hung over from animal massacres, hung over from murder and mayhem, From multiple violations of place and people.

- 17 The violence you have done to Lebanon will overwhelm you, and your destruction of animals will terrify you. For you have shed man's blood; you have destroyed lands and cities and everyone in them.
- 18 "What's the use of a carved god so skillfully carved by its sculptor? What good is a fancy cast god when all it tells is lies? What sense does it make to be a pious god-maker who makes gods that can't even talk?
- 18 Of what value is an idol, since a man has carved it? Or an image that teaches lies? For he who makes it trusts in his own creation; he makes idols that cannot speak.
- 19 Who do you think you are-- saying to a stick of wood, 'Wake up,' Or to a dumb stone, 'Get up'? Can they teach you anything about anything? There's nothing to them but surface. There's nothing on the inside.
- 19 Woe to him who says to wood, 'Come to life!' Or to lifeless stone, 'Wake up!' Can it give guidance? It is covered with gold and silver; there is no breath in it.
- 20 "But oh! GOD is in his holy Temple! Quiet everyone--a holy silence. Listen!"
- 20 But the LORD is in his holy temple; let all the earth be silent before him."

Habakkuk 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 A prayer of the prophet Habakkuk, with orchestra:
- 1 A prayer of Habakkuk the prophet. On shigionoth.
- 2 GOD, I've heard what our ancestors say about you, and I'm stopped in my tracks, down on my knees. Do among us what you did among them. Work among us as you worked among them. And as you bring judgment, as you surely must, remember mercy.
- 2 LORD, I have heard of your fame; I stand in awe of your deeds, O LORD. Renew them in our day, in our time make them known; in wrath remember mercy.
- 3 God's on his way again, retracing the old salvation route, Coming up from the south through Teman, the Holy One from Mount Paran. Skies are blazing with his splendor, his praises sounding through the earth,

- 3 God came from Teman, the Holy One from Mount Paran. Selah His glory covered the heavens and his praise filled the earth.
- 4 His cloud-brightness like dawn, exploding, spreading, forked-lightning shooting from his hand-- what power hidden in that fist!
- 4 His splendor was like the sunrise; rays flashed from his hand, where his power was hidden.
- 5 Plague marches before him, pestilence at his heels!
- 5 Plague went before him; pestilence followed his steps.
- 6 He stops. He shakes Earth. He looks around. Nations tremble. The age-old mountains fall to pieces; ancient hills collapse like a spent balloon. The paths God takes are older than the oldest mountains and hills.
- 6 He stood, and shook the earth; he looked, and made the nations tremble. The ancient mountains crumbled and the age-old hills collapsed. His ways are eternal.
- 7 I saw everyone worried, in a panic: Old wilderness adversaries, Cushan and Midian, were terrified, hoping he wouldn't notice them.
- 7 I saw the tents of Cushan in distress, the dwellings of Midian in anguish.
- 8 GOD, is it River you're mad at? Angry at old River? Were you raging at Sea when you rode horse and chariot through to salvation?
- 8 Were you angry with the rivers, O LORD? Was your wrath against the streams? Did you rage against the sea when you rode with your horses and your victorious chariots?
- 9 You unfurled your bow and let loose a volley of arrows. You split Earth with rivers.
- 9 You uncovered your bow, you called for many arrows. Selah You split the earth with rivers;
- 10 Mountains saw what was coming. They twisted in pain. Flood Waters poured in. Ocean roared and reared huge waves.
- 10 the mountains saw you and writhed. Torrents of water swept by; the deep roared and lifted its waves on high.
- 11 Sun and Moon stopped in their tracks. Your flashing arrows stopped them, your lightning-strike spears impaled them.
- 11 Sun and moon stood still in the heavens at the glint of your flying arrows, at the lightning of your flashing spear.
- 12 Angry, you stomped through Earth. Furious, you crushed the godless nations.

- 12 In wrath you strode through the earth and in anger you threshed the nations.
- 13 You were out to save your people, to save your specially chosen people. You beat the stuffing out of King Wicked, Stripped him naked from head to toe,
- 13 You came out to deliver your people, to save your anointed one. You crushed the leader of the land of wickedness, you stripped him from head to foot. Selah
- 14 Set his severed head on his own spear and blew away his army. Scattered they were to the four winds-- and ended up food for the sharks!
- 14 With his own spear you pierced his head when his warriors stormed out to scatter us, gloating as though about to devour the wretched who were in hiding.
- 15 You galloped through the Sea on your horses, racing on the crest of the waves.
- 15 You trampled the sea with your horses, churning the great waters.
- 16 When I heard it, my stomach did flips. I stammered and stuttered. My bones turned to water. I staggered and stumbled. I sit back and wait for Doomsday to descend on our attackers.
- 16 I heard and my heart pounded, my lips quivered at the sound; decay crept into my bones, and my legs trembled. Yet I will wait patiently for the day of calamity to come on the nation invading us.
- 17 Though the cherry trees don't blossom and the strawberries don't ripen, Though the apples are worm-eaten and the wheat fields stunted, Though the sheep pens are sheepless and the cattle barns empty,
- 17 Though the fig tree does not bud and there are no grapes on the vines, though the olive crop fails and the fields produce no food, though there are no sheep in the pen and no cattle in the stalls,
- 18 I'm singing joyful praise to GOD. I'm turning cartwheels of joy to my Savior God.
- 18 yet I will rejoice in the LORD, I will be joyful in God my Savior.
- 19 Counting on GOD's Rule to prevail, I take heart and gain strength. I run like a deer. I feel like I'm king of the mountain! (For congregational use, with a full orchestra.)
- 19 The Sovereign LORD is my strength; he makes my feet like the feet of a deer, he enables me to go on the heights. For the director of music. On

my stringed instruments.